

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

21 May 1984

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

1 FURTHER TO OUR MESSAGE OF 10 MAY REGARDING TORTURE BEING
INFLECTED BAHÁ'ÍS IRAN WE SEND FOLLOWING SUMMARY OVERALL SITUATION
THAT COUNTRY FROM MOST RECENT INFORMATION PROVIDED BY RELIABLE
SOURCES.

1 SINCE THE BEGINNING OF THE ISLAMIC REVOLUTION MORE THAN 300
RESIDENCES OF BAHÁ'ÍS HAVE BEEN PLUNDERED OR SET ON FIRE.

2 SOME 170 BAHÁ'ÍS, MOST OF THEM PROMINENT MEMBERS OF THE BAHÁ'Í
COMMUNITY, HAVE BEEN KILLED BY A VARIETY OF METHODS, BUT PRINCIPALLY
THROUGH EXECUTION BY FIRING SQUADS AND BY HANGING.

3 IN URBAN AREAS PROPERTIES BELONGING TO SEVERAL HUNDRED
FAMILIES HAVE BEEN SEIZED, WHILE IN RURAL AREAS MANY ORCHARDS HAVE
BEEN DESTROYED AND FARMS AND ARABLE LANDS CONFISCATED. PETITIONS TO
THE AUTHORITIES FOR REDRESS OF GRIEVANCES HAVE BEEN IGNORED.

4 THE MINISTRY OF WORKS AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS FORMALLY INSTRUCTED
INDUSTRIAL AND COMMERCIAL INSTITUTIONS NOT TO PAY THEIR BAHÁ'Í STAFF.

5 MORE THAN 10,000 BAHÁ'ÍS EMPLOYED IN GOVERNMENT OFFICES OR IN
THE PRIVATE SECTOR HAVE BEEN SUMMARILY DISCHARGED, THEIR RIGHTS TO
PENSIONS AND OTHER EMPLOYMENT BENEFITS REVOKED. DEMANDS WERE
MADE OF A NUMBER OF THEM TO REFUND THE SALARIES THEY HAD RECEIVED
FOR THE DURATION OF THEIR EMPLOYMENT.

6 BAHÁ'Í STUDENTS HAVE BEEN DISMISSED FROM ALL UNIVERSITIES AND
OTHER INSTITUTIONS OF HIGHER LEARNING.

7 IN MOST CITIES AND PROVINCES, BAHÁ'Í CHILDREN HAVE BEEN DENIED
ENTRY TO SCHOOLS AND THEREFORE HAVE NO ACCESS TO BASIC EDUCATION.

8 SOME 700 BAHÁ'ÍS, INCLUDING MEN, WOMEN AND CHILDREN, ARE BEING
HELD IN VARIOUS PRISONS THROUGHOUT IRAN.

9 FOR MORE THAN NINE MONTHS VISITS TO 40 BAHÁ'Í PRISONERS HAVE
BEEN STRICTLY PROHIBITED BY THE AUTHORITIES. THEIR FATE IS THEREFORE
UNKNOWN.

10 IN EVIN AND GAWHAR-DASHT PRISONS A NUMBER OF BAHÁ'Í PRISONERS
ARE UNDERGOING RELENTLESS TORTURE IN AN EFFORT ON THE PART OF THE
AUTHORITIES TO FORCE THEM TO ADMIT TO FALSE CHARGES OF ENGAGING IN

ESPIONAGE AND ACTING AGAINST THE ISLAMIC REPUBLIC OF IRAN. FOR A PERIOD OF MONTHS THEY HAVE BEEN SUBJECTED TO FLOGGINGS OF ALL PARTS OF THE BODY, PARTICULARLY THE LEGS AND FEET. SOMETIMES UP TO 400 STROKES BY WIRE CABLES HAVE BEEN ADMINISTERED TO ONE PRISONER, THEN HE OR SHE HAS BEEN MADE TO WALK. FINDING THIS IMPOSSIBLE, THE UNFORTUNATE PRISONER HAS BEEN FORCED TO CRAWL ON HANDS AND KNEES BACK TO A DARK CELL. IN MASHHAD AND YAZD BAHÁ'Í PRISONERS ARE REGULARLY WHIPPED ON THE HEAD AND FACE WITH THICK PLASTIC TUBES, SIMILAR PROCEDURES ARE USED TO A LESSER DEGREE IN OTHER PRISONS. A NUMBER OF THESE VICTIMS OF TORTURE HAVE LOST THEIR SIGHT AND HEARING, OTHERS THEIR MENTAL COMPETENCE. THE BODIES OF FOUR PRISONERS SUBJECTED TO SUCH TREATMENT WERE SEEN BEFORE BEING BURIED IN UNKNOWN GRAVES. IT IS THEREFORE FEARED THAT OTHER PRISONERS WHOSE BODIES HAVE BEEN SIMILARLY BURIED WITHOUT THEIR FAMILIES BEING NOTIFIED SUFFERED THE SAME FATE.

¹¹ BAHÁ'ÍS ARE UNSAFE IN THEIR OWN HOMES, WHICH ARE ENTERED AT WILL, DAY OR NIGHT, BY REVOLUTIONARY GUARDS, WHO HARASS THE INHABITANTS BY INSULTING, THREATENING AND BEATING THEM. WHEN THE REVOLUTIONARY GUARDS INVADE A HOME WITH THE INTENTION OF ARRESTING A PARTICULAR BAHÁ'Í, IF THAT PERSON HAPPENS TO BE ABSENT, THEIR PRACTICE IS TO SEIZE AS HOSTAGES OTHER MEMBERS OF THE HOUSEHOLD, EVEN CHILDREN, AND TO RANSACK THE PLACE, CONFISCATING WHATEVER THEY PLEASE.

¹² WHENEVER THE HEAD OR SOME OTHER IMPORTANT MEMBER OF THE FAMILY HAS BEEN KILLED, AND OFTEN WHEN SUCH A PERSON HAS BEEN IMPRISONED, THOSE REMAINING BEHIND HAVE BEEN FORCED FROM THEIR HOMES AND NOT PERMITTED TO TAKE ANY BELONGINGS, EVEN IN THE DEAD OF WINTER. THE VICTIMS OF SUCH TREATMENT HAVE NO RECOURSE TO JUSTICE SINCE THEIR PETITIONS TO THE AUTHORITIES ARE IGNORED. BAHÁ'Í FAMILIES IN ISFAHAN, MASHHAD, TEHRAN, URÚMÍYYIH AND YAZD IN PARTICULAR ARE AFFECTED BY THESE CONDITIONS....

¹³ FOLLOWING INFORMATION JUST RECEIVED: EXECUTION FOUR MORE COURAGEOUS BRETHREN IRAN

BOTH TORTURED DURING IMPRISONMENT

¹⁴ IN ADDITION, MR. ASADU'LLÁH KÁMIL-MUQADDAM DIED IN PRISON 2 MAY, CIRCUMSTANCES UNKNOWN.

¹⁵ FRIENDS IRAN FEEL SITUATION DANGEROUS GREAT NUMBER OTHER BAHÁ'Í PRISONERS....

UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]